

MATTHIAS REBELLIOUS, CEO, Smart Infrastructure, and Member of the Managing Board of German conglomerate Siemens AG, tells Business Today why Donald Trump's stance on climate change is not yet a threat and why he is optimistic about India. Edited excerpts:



What is your assessment of the India market and Siemen's operations over the decades?

I'm very optimistic on India's future as we always have been. But I think in the last two, three years the government is acting to really transform sectors. Our investments in India since 2015 is about ₹9,000 crore, out of which more than ₹1,000 crore was in 2023. A lot of it was in smart infrastructure; also in our factories with a growing demand and increasing localisation.



Matthias Rebellius

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What are the growth areas?

There is a very clear focus on modernising the railways. We have invested in rolling stock. We've invested in bogies, in locomotives, etc. We are looking at smart infrastructure. We did an acquisition a couple of years ago of C&S Electric and are still looking for inorganic growth, while continuing to expand localisation in India.



With AI getting mainstream, energy demand is expected to rise. Do you see India meeting the demand?

That's a challenge for all governments in the world. Globally, energy demand is increasing exponentially and is still far from the peak. With DeepSeek, there's new technology which perhaps you can do it with less energy which will balance this a little bit.

So, I expect the energy demand of data centres to increase, but perhaps not on that level as in the last two years. However, while we must meet

Q&A

“Optimistic about India”

Matthias Rebellius, CEO, Smart Infrastructure, and Member of Managing Board, Siemens AG on the company's growth plans

BY ARNAB DUTTA

the huge increase in energy demand while keeping the [environmental] balance. The amount of investment that is required is equal to build almost the same amount of grid which we have globally.



Does US President Trump's stance on climate change and spending affect your company's plans?

I strongly believe one individual will not change the world [policies]. It is clear the world economy and leaders mainly agree on what needs to be done.

It is of course not supportive if large societies and governments now hold back or slow down activities. If you spend on the right projects now, you will save later. **BT**

@arndutt